

STEPHEN WAITS

A distinguished software engineer with 30+ years in development and strategic leadership.

I. LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY

My leadership starts with relationships, building trust through empathy, active listening, and data-driven decisions centered on customer needs. As a force multiplier, I level up large, cross-functional teams and individuals without direct management, empowering them to lead, innovate, and think independently. I set high standards by example, motivating teams toward a shared purpose that drives both individual fulfillment and impactful business outcomes.

II. EXPERIENCE

Amazon **June 2022 – Present**

Principal Engineer, Prime and Marketing Technology

- Building and driving a unified architecture for automated merchandising content curation across Amazon.
- Leading large-scale system design of end-to-end automation for all marketing campaigns, worldwide.
- Aiming for 100x increase in merchandising and marketing capacity through automation and generative AI.
- As an IC, leading end-to-end engineering and set the bar for technical excellence on my team (VP-level, ~600 HC).
- Influencing specific technology strategies across skip-level organization (SVP-level, ~22K HC).

Principal Engineer, Fulfillment Technology and Robotics

- Solely responsible for design, implementation, and adoption of a large-scale federated simulation framework.
- Built tech which enables significant optimization of the world's largest fulfillment network (>50M packages/day).

Ongoing Amazon-wide, cross-role work . . .

- Created and piloting company-wide L7 IC Leadership Development training program.
- Producer for Principals of Amazon, the longest running internal weekly tech talk series, for an audience of ~180K.
- Track owner for DevCon '23, '24, & '25, an internal developer conference attended by $\approx \frac{1}{3}$ of tech employees (~60K).

Zwift **November 2021 – May 2022**

Distinguished Engineer

- Led ~150 engineers in best practices, design, coding, and operation of world's largest online cycling game.
- Initiated and led rewrite of SDE levels to provide clearer, more achievable standards while raising the talent bar.
- Set exemplary bar for ingenuity and speed by designing and implementing a top-tier player rating system.

Amazon **September 2016 – November 2021**

Principal Engineer, Amazon Fashion

- Lead technical IC across entire Amazon Fashion CX, the largest apparel retailer in the world (>\$40B annual).
- Additionally led tech on Personal Shopper, Try Before You Buy, Luxury Stores, and Amazon Style physical stores.
- Contributed to a 76% reduction in Personal Shopper style time through tech and operational improvements.
- Pivotal in the rapid launch of Style physical stores in under 2 years (amid pandemic) by driving tech pragmatism.
- Led design and implementation of Amazon-wide customer preference system used by 350M+, scalable to 20M tps.
- Created metric to boost COE (post-incident analysis) quality and priority, leading its adoption by ~8,000 engineers.

Principal Engineer, Amazon Fresh and Whole Foods

- Sole PE and most senior engineer in a ~1,200 person organization, leading ~600 engineers as an IC.
- Collaborated across Whole Foods, Amazon Fresh (online and physical stores), PrimeNow, and Restaurants.
- Directed tech design and implementations across supply-chain, e-commerce, fulfillment, delivery, and returns.
- Post-acquisition of Whole Foods Market, shaped and led its integration into Amazon's online shopping experience.

Leaselabs **March 2015 – August 2016**

Associate VP of Technology

Sony PlayStation¹ **March 2000 – March 2015**

Engineer → Lead Engineer → Manager → Senior Manager

Stormfront Studios¹ **April 1996 – March 2000**

Engineer → Lead Engineer

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University **April 1994 – April 1996**

System and Network Administrator

¹Visit <https://swaits.com/about> for full list of shipped games.



III. PATENTS

AUTOMATIC CAMERA CONFIGURATION USING A FIDUCIAL MARKER (US 10453216): “Systems and associated methods are disclosed for automatically configuring cameras to be associated with a known physical location in response to exposing the camera to a fiducial marker.”

IV. ELIGIBILITY AND LOCATION

- **Eligibility:** United States Citizen
- **Location:** Considering full-time remote opportunities, allowing work from home in Draper, UT.
- **Travel Availability:** Can travel as required, up to several times per month.

V. EDUCATION

✈ **Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University** **Fall 1990 – Spring 1994**
B.S. Aeronautical Science (partial)

VI. REFERENCES

👤 Managers

Name	Current title and company		Managed me as ...
Leon Warman	Distinguished Engineer	Coupage	Sr. PE , Amazon Robotics
Margot Johnson	Chief Digital Officer	Aritzia	Director, Amazon Fashion
Paul Horvath	CTO	uShip	Director, Amazon Grocery
Tony Bacos	CTO+CPO	StitchFix	VP, Amazon Fashion
YuChiang Cheng	Entrepreneur and Investor	<i>independent</i>	CTO+CPO Zwiift

👤 Peers

Name	Current title and company		Worked together at ...
Avi Romascanu	Principal Staff Software Engineer	LinkedIn	Amazon Fashion
Chris Chavez	CTO	Shopbop	Shopbop (Amazon)
James Grafton	Director, Partner Engineering	Meta	Zwiift
Jenn Green	Principal Engineer	Amazon Retail	Amazon Fashion
Ken Chao	Sr. Manager	Netflix	Stormfront Studios
Kevin Lloyd	Director, Software Engineering	Amazon Grocery	Amazon Grocery
Nate Wiger	CTO	Pipe	PlayStation, Amazon Grocery
Nigel Storey	CTO	Zappos	Amazon Fashion
Ralf Knoesel	CTO	Vector Unit	Stormfront Studios
Simon Johnston	Sr. Principal Engineer	Amazon Ads	Amazon Grocery, Fashion
Spencer Voorheis	Principal Engineer	Amazon PXT	Amazon Grocery

VII. DIGITAL SIGNATURE

I publish a GnuPG signature which you can use to verify this document’s authenticity. Fetch the latest résumé PDF², its digital signature³, and my public key⁴. Then verify with:

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> gpg --import personal.asc.txt && gpg --verify resume-public.pdf.asc resume-public.pdf
```

```
gpg: Signature made <DATE AND TIME>
gpg:          using RSA key 3A8B02E4C8C508B615424A36943ECEA0A1FD4EEC
gpg: Good signature from "Stephen Waits <steve@waits.net>" [ultimate]
```

²<https://swaits.com/resume-public.pdf>

³<https://swaits.com/resume-public.pdf.asc>

⁴<https://swaits.com/crypto/swaits-personal.asc>

